Salesforce research evolution

Project 1 corporate finance application. Analysis prepared October 19 2026 with Codex assistance. Economic valuation date August 27 2026, USD, NYSE CRM common shares, diluted proxy 824M. Intended user is a buy-side PM/committee holding no position; horizon 12-24 months; decision is initiate, watch/defer or do not initiate under explicit conditions.

Edition A unchanged baseline status

An authentic Salesforce AI-closed Edition A PDF and first successful Brightspace checkpoint receipt were not available. They are not reconstructed. The existing workspace file `projects/project-1-edition-a-nvda.md` concerns NVIDIA and a September 1 2026 valuation. A byte-identical copy is preserved at `evidence/edition-a-existing-nvidia-unchanged.md`, SHA256 `FF289D7D83BF56F977D5D3F85F7CDF13125841075D5E8A59AF03FA845D39ED6B`. Its receipt, PDF identity and AI-closed authorship have not been verified. It is evidence of a different target document, not proof of a Salesforce baseline.

No earlier timestamp, student attestation, supervised observation, approval or successful receipt is invented. An unchanged authentic PDF can be added if supplied, with any factual correction in a dated addendum. If absent, the student must disclose the target switch and seek the instructor's recovery/target-change ruling. The course architecture states that a missing on-time Edition A cannot be recreated; its A-to-B evidence is absent under Problem Definition, without a second penalty elsewhere merely for that same missing comparison.

Dated target-change addendum October 19 2026

The user expressly selected Salesforce for this project. The retained NVIDIA labs and baseline remain unchanged and outside the Salesforce valuation engine. Company, security, drivers, sources, balance-sheet basis and decision have all been rebuilt for CRM. This is a disclosed scope change; no claim is made that the instructor already approved a late company switch. Source retrieval is October 19; the economic cutoff is August 27 and later facts are excluded.

Edition B current judgment

Watch/defer at the August 27 close 252.05. Five-year FCFF cases support approximately 75-300 per diluted share, with base near 195. No current position should be initiated without a20% margin of safety, two-quarter operating confirmation and bridge/acquisition checks. Model judgment is conditional on the subscription/operating/capital assumptions, not the original screening decision.

The consequential research checks are the reported-to-normalized LTM bridge, stock-compensation treatment and current debt/share reconciliation. All 22 automated tests pass. The official course DCF and nine-cell sensitivity answers reconcile; balance sheets and cash flow articulate across 30 forecast case/stress years. An economically invalid recurring-SBC addback is explicitly rejected: it inflates value by roughly 90 per share while leaving shareholder cost unmodeled.

A-to-B evidence table

Item	Edition A evidence available	Edition B	Driver and evidence
Thesis and action	No authenticated same-company Salesforce baseline. NVIDIA text admits research, not a CRM buy.	CRM watch/defer; downside can reverse to do not initiate.	User selected new target; AI-assisted filing research, engine and stress tests; student judgment review remains required.

Item	Edition A evidence available	Edition B	Driver and evidence
Sources and dates	NVIDIA source file belongs to another issuer/date; no Salesforce receipt.	Salesforce annual/interim filings, Treasury and aligned peer prices public by Aug 27.	Primary-source check and data-definition reconciliation; data/sources.json and evidence/data-lineage.md.
Assumptions and design	No historical Salesforce pre-AI driver plan can be asserted.	Subscription cohorts; five-year linked statements; economically retained compensation; FCFF engine; terminal reinvestment.	Course-required architecture plus disclosed AI implementation, official known answers and statement invariants.
Risks and uncertainty	A same-company pre-AI uncertainty list is unavailable.	Terminal dependence, acquired growth, investment gains, new debt/current shares, pending M&A.	Filing facts and independently reproducible accounting/valuation checks; no invented partner attribution.

Tested AI outputs and revisions

The assistant's early code exposed a compensation rate without linking changes to earnings. That output was **corrected**: increasing the recurring rate 8% to 9% now lowers EBIT, cash and per-share value. The independent anchor is the filing's compensation expense and shareholder claim; the changed-input test confirms actual propagation. The assistant also corrected omitted finance-lease amortization and prevented a pending acquisition cash outflow from being rolled into pre-cutoff cash.

The highest-risk demonstration **rejects** an unoffset SBC cash-flow addback against the 10-Q compensation and cash-flow definitions. Course known answers independently benchmark the DCF arithmetic; AI agreement does not serve as external evidence. These are assistant dispositions presented for student review, not fabricated statements of the student's personal pre-AI reasoning.

What changed from Edition A to Edition B and why

The observable change is a target switch from an existing NVIDIA document to a new Salesforce evidence/model package, plus the documented corrections above. A genuine same-company A-to-B judgment comparison cannot be established from the available material. Do not label this no material change or claim that AI improved a missing historical Salesforce judgment. Edition B and Video 1 remain required even with the disclosed baseline gap; see the validation record and student actions for the remaining ownership requirements.